

: From Word to Text.

—SYNTAX

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CONTENTS

01

Syntactic relations

03

endocentric & exocentric constructions

02

Grammatical construction

04

Conclusion



01

Syntactic relations



01 Syntactic relations



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Positional
Relation
位置关系



Relations of
Substitutability
替代关系



Relations of
Co-Occurrence
同现关系



01 Syntactic relations: Positional Relation



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Positional relation, or word order, refers to the **sequential arrangement** of words in a language. (横向)
six types: SVO, VSO, SOV, OVS, OSV, VOS

eg.

English: I am Mr. Zhao. —SVO

Chinese: 我是赵老师。 —SVO

French: Je suis Professeur Zhao. —SVO

Japanese: わたしは趙先生です。 —SOV

Arabic: المعلم أنا تشاو —VSO

practice: Please rearrange them into a sentence.

not into gentle go night do good that

worth unexamined not the living life is

lonely a wandered I cloud as



01 Syntactic relations: Relations of Substitutability



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The relation of substitutability refers to **classes or sets of words** **substitutable** for each other grammatically in sentences with the same structure.

eg.

(a) *The strong man/tallest boy/pretty girl smiles.*

(b) *He went there yesterday/last week/the day before.*

In (a) one can make a choice from the **nominal groups**, whereas in (b) one can make a choice from the **adverbial groups**.

This is what Saussure called **associative relations**, or in Hjelmslev's term, **paradigmatic relations**. To make it more understandable, they are called **vertical relations** or **choice relations**.



01 Syntactic relations: Relations of Co-Occurrence



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It means that words of different sets of clauses may permit, or require, the occurrence of a word of another set or class to form a sentence or a particular part of a sentence.

eg.

(preceded by)

NP

(followed by)

An ugly

boy

shouted.

The annoying

woman

has been exhausted.

The wise

teacher

won't fail students.



02

Grammatical construction



02 Grammatical construction 语法结构



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1

Grammatical Construction or construct can mean any **syntactic construct** which is assigned one or more **conventional functions** in a language, together with whatever is linguistically conventionalized about its contribution to the meaning or use the construct contains.



02 Grammatical construction—— immediate constituents直接成分 → phrases



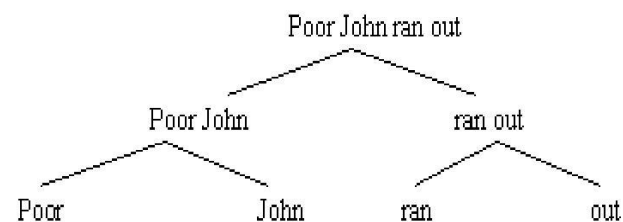
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Constituent: 成分

a term used in structural sentence analysis for every linguistic unit, which is a part of a larger linguistic unit.

IC analysis ←

Immediate Constituent Analysis



02 Grammatical construction



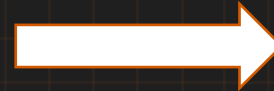
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02 Grammatical construction



Word-level



Phrasal

Major lexical categories	Examples
Noun (N)	book, boy, love, sheep
Verb (V)	run, read, play
Adjective (A)	happy, tall, clear
Preposition (P)	about, over, on
Minor lexical categories	Examples
Determiner (Det)	the, a, this, those
Degree words (Deg)	quite, very, more, so
Qualifier (Qual)	often, always, seldom, almost
Auxiliary (Aux)	must, should, can, might
Conjunction (Con)	and, but, or

NP=noun phrase

AP=adjective phrase

VP=verb phrase

PP=prepositional phrase

S=sentence or clause

The S rule: $S = NP + VP$

03

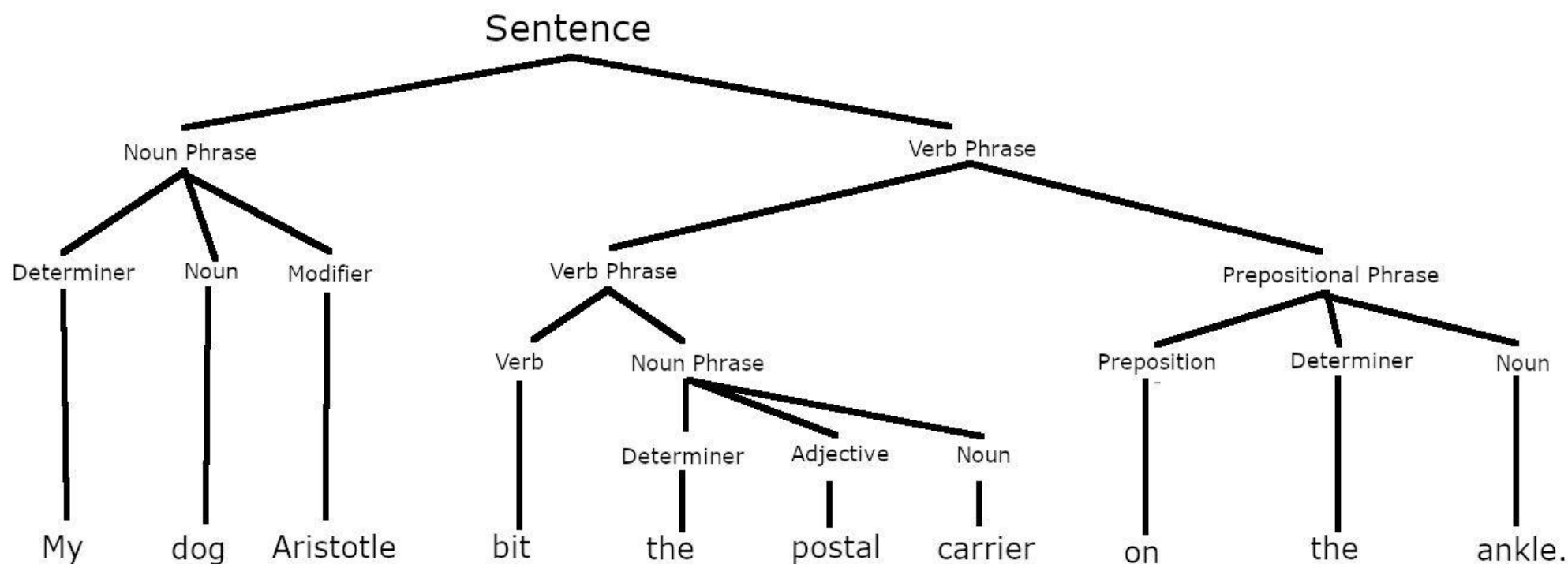
endocentric & exocentric
constructions

02 Grammatical construction



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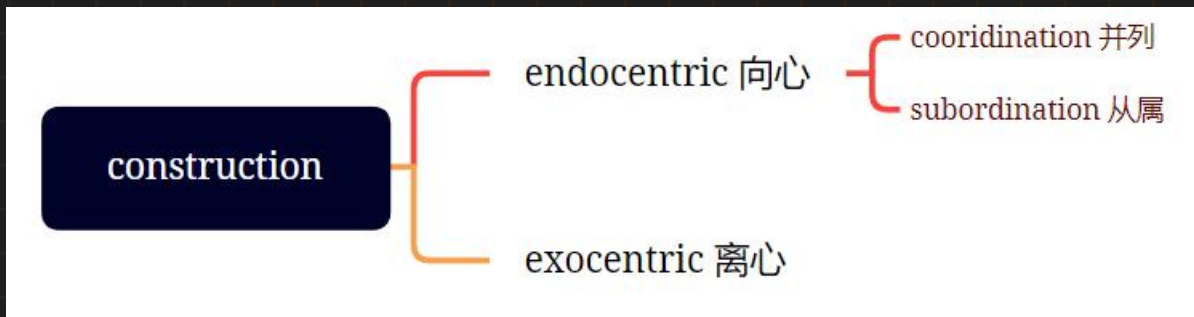
Tree Diagram 树状图



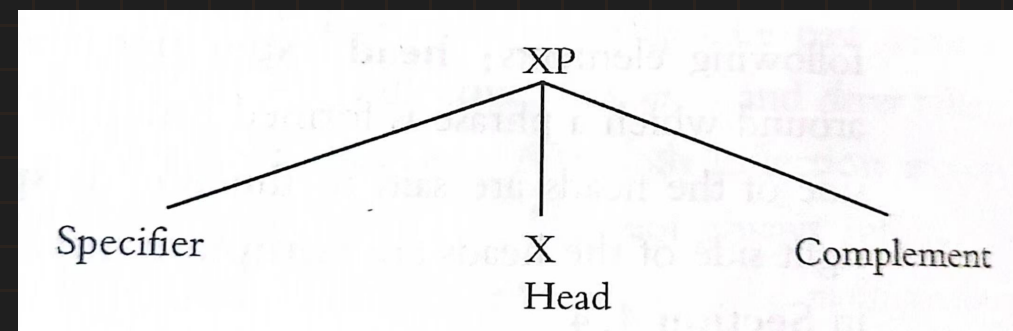
03 endocentric constructions



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X rule



Endocentric construction 向心结构

is one whose distribution is functionally equivalent to that of one or more of its constituents, i.e. a word or a group of words, which serves as a definable **centre** or **head** (中心) .

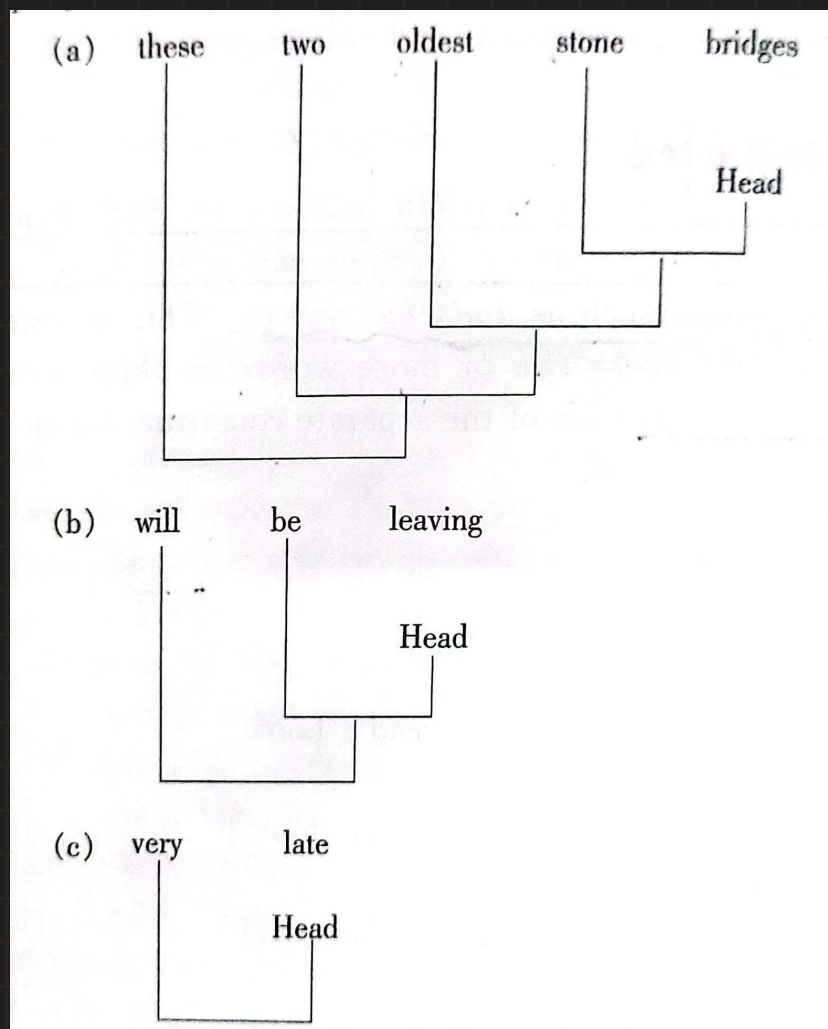
X: the head N,V,A or P



03 endocentric constructions



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noun phrases



verb phrases



adjective phrases



03 endocentric constructions



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Coordination 并列

is formed by grouping together two or more categories of the same type with the help of a **conjunction** such as and, but and or. And these two or more words or phrases or clauses have equivalent syntactic status.

Subordination 从属

refers to the process or result of linking linguistic units so that they have different syntactic status, one being dependent upon the other, and usually a constituent of the other.



03 exocentric constructions



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Exocentric construction 离心结构

refers to a group of syntactically related words where none of the words is functionally equivalent to the group as a whole, that is, there is no definable "Centre" or "Head" inside the group.

eg.

Mr. Zhao smiled.

Mrs. Li hit her face.

Mr. Li gossips in class.

SV

VO

PP



Time for test !



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1. Please analyse the structure using the tree diagram.

The boy ate the egg on the table.

2. endocentric (向心) or exocentric (离心) construction?
(the underlined parts)

Alice seemed sad.

I ran down the stairs and out the door.



04 Conclusion



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The use of language, like games, has its own rules. To play the games well, you should know the rules. Words, word groups and phrases, and clauses cannot occur at random, they have to follow certain rules of ordering.



THANKS FOR WATCHING!

